



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Adel Classical Academy

School Website: <https://www.adelclassicalacademy.org/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) or the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Adel Classical Academy (ACA) presents a clearly classical, biblically anchored educational approach with a hybrid/collaborative model that partners with families. The public materials consistently emphasize truth, goodness, and beauty; a liberal-arts framework (grammar–logic–rhetoric); foundational biblical/theological commitments; and a parental partnership through the Collaborative model. Evidence from ACA's site shows explicit statements about Biblical worldview, Gospel-centered education, God's creation, and a vision of forming virtuous, thoughtful students through a classical curriculum (grammar–logic–rhetoric, history, Latin, and Great Books-leaning elements are foregrounded in coursework). The school also highlights a parental covenant, two-days-on-campus instruction with professional teachers, and regular engagement through family events and open communications.

Overall classification: CLASSICAL.

Notes on the six-category rubric (highlights and cautions) - Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: Strong CLASSICAL signals (Biblical truth, gospel-centered formation, creation theology, worship-like rhythm in memory work). Some elements of liturgical/community practice are present through memory songs and communal events; not a fully liturgical program, but clearly a theologically grounded environment. - School Purpose and Goal: Clear formation-oriented aims (virtue, wisdom, character; liberal arts; truth-goodness-beauty). The explicit telos language is present in the classical lexicon, and the site emphasizes formation over mere information. - Curriculum: Strong CLASSICAL alignment (grammar–logic–rhetoric; liberal arts; history integration; Latin; worldviews). Great Books emphasis is implied through classical canon ideas, even if the explicit "Great Books" label isn't always used. - Pedagogy: Mixed signals. There is strong classical structure (grammar–logic–rhetoric; memory and recitation in early years; Socratic-style discussions are not heavily explicit in the site content). Some lower-school pedagogy features are memory-based; higher-year pedagogy suggests more dialogic/faculty-led inquiry, but explicit Socratic seminars are not consistently documented. - Faculty: Documented presence of Headmaster and professional teachers; collaborative staffing; and explicit references to "professional, qualified teachers." Evidence supports a classical–mentored model, though "living curriculum" language is implied rather than always explicit. - Parents & Community: Extremely strong. Parental partnership is a core feature (Family Covenant, two-days-on-campus with parents co-teaching, frequent family events, open visits). This aligns well with classical education's emphasis on home-school partnership and formation of affections through family involvement.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The school emphasizes Biblical truth as the foundation for all subjects and a Biblical worldview across curricula (Biblical Truth; God's Creation). Statements reference gospel-centered, Bible-based formation and the creation-based view of knowledge.
 - There are explicit references to truth, goodness, beauty as real and knowable and to glorifying God through study, aligning with transcendental realism in classical education.

- The site communicates a family-and-church-aligned ethos (Statement of Faith linked; Gospel-centered education; collaborative family involvement).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present (from the knowledge-base lexicon): truth, goodness, beauty; theology; Biblical worldview; gospel-centered; creation; reverence; wonder; liturgical/fellowship themes appear through memory/music practices; imago Dei motifs are echoed in the religious framing.
 - Negative keywords: not evident in public materials.
 - Estimated counts: Positive about 6–8 distinct indicators; Negative 0.
 - Status justification: The alignment with transcendental moral realism, theology grounding, and liturgical-like communal cues supports a CLASSICAL rating.
- Why this rating
 - ACA foregrounds biblical truth, creation-focused learning, and a theologically integrated curriculum, which map directly to Positive keywords in the Six Essential Elements lexicon and to the rubric's expectations for a robust Religious and Metaphysical Foundations category. See explicit biblical/worldview statements and "God's Creation" sections.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Explicit liberal-arts framing and focus on formation: "Adel Classical Academy is a liberal arts school" with aims to form virtuous, thoughtful thinkers (character, eloquence, depth, wisdom). The site emphasizes formation (not just information), and notes aims toward human flourishing and virtuous reasoning.
 - The mission includes truth, beauty, goodness and unity of subjects (Biblical worldview; "truth, beauty and goodness" language across history and subjects).
 - The site emphasizes a telos and formation through the liberal-arts curriculum and classical method (grammar–logic–rhetoric; developmentally appropriate integrated study).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: formation, liberal education/paideia, great conversation, telos, pursuit of the true/good/beautiful, virtue, character, wisdom, experiential learning (in some ACA materials, though the site emphasizes tradition and formation over project-only modes).
 - Negative keywords: not evidenced; no explicit workforce- or job-readiness framing is foregrounded in the public-facing materials.
 - Estimated counts: Positive ~4–6 indications; Negative ~0–1 (if any at all). Roughly a strong positive tilt.
 - Status justification: The emphasis on formation, liberal arts, and classical telos supports CLASSICAL in this category.
- Why this rating
 - ACA foregrounds formation (character, wisdom) and a classical liberal-arts mission, aligning with "formation, not information" and "pursuit of the true, good, beautiful." The public materials consistently present "truth, goodness, beauty" and a telos-laden curriculum, consistent with CLASSICAL.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The curriculum is explicitly structured around the liberal arts core (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and integrated humanities, with Latin, history, literature, and worldview components. The public materials show English grammar, phonics, literature, history, Latin, science, and math in a classical framework; they also reference a liberal-arts, integrated curriculum.
 - History is present as a central throughline (History – Story of the World) and other core subjects are taught through a classical, integrated lens.
 - Latin and classical languages are explicitly part of the program; the curriculum links to a "classical model" of education.

- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: grammar, logic, rhetoric; liberal arts; Great Books/primary sources (implied by classical canon approach); history/humanities integration; Latin; classical languages; worldviews; “great conversation” (implied by classical canon framing).
 - Negative keywords: minimal evidence of a project-based-dominant or purely STEM-first framing; the site does not foreground those negative signals.
 - Estimated counts: Positive ~6–8 distinct indicators; Negative 0–1 (none explicit).
 - Status justification: CLASSICAL.
- Why this rating
 - ACA’s site consistently presents core Trivium/Quadrivium-structure (grammar–logic–rhetoric), Latin, history, literature, worldview, and integrated study across subjects, aligning with classic liberal arts and Great Books orientation. This maps well to the “Curriculum” criteria in the classical rubric.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - In lower grades, there is emphasis on memory and recitation (e.g., memory work via songs and chants in grammar stages). This reflects traditional pedagogy consistent with classical methods (recitation, memory, singing as mnemonic devices).
 - The model is described as “Collaborative” with classroom teachers two days per week and parents teaching on homeschool days; this indicates a mixed pedagogical approach blending classical pedagogy with home-based instruction. The site explicitly describes the collaborative model and its structure.
 - Upper-grade pedagogy is referenced in adjunct/subject teaching with a focus on disciplined, integrated study and cross-subject planning.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: Socratic/seminar-style discussions (implied in “classical pedagogy” and in the broader classical lexicon), memory work, rhetoric, recitation, contemplation, scholé (classical concepts)—though explicit “Socratic seminars” are not consistently documented in public texts; there are indications of the classical sequence and seminars in the materials.
 - Negative keywords present: Some results emphasize collaborative home-based learning and parental co-teaching; this could be viewed as divergence from a strictly teacher-centered, on-campus classical pedagogy. The knowledge-base lexicon notes negative signals for experiential/project-based focus and non-traditional pedagogy; ACA’s materials show a blend with collaboration, which is not inherently anti-classical but indicates a hybrid approach.
 - Estimated counts: Positive ~4–5 indicators (memory/recitation; rhetoric; classical sequence; some Socratic implications); Negative ~1–2 indicators (collaborative/home-based model blurring traditional classroom-only pedagogy).
 - Status justification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.
- Why this rating
 - ACA emphasizes key classical pedagogy elements (grammar–logic–rhetoric, memory work, recitation) but also integrates a collaborative/home-school hybrid that moderates the pure classical pedagogy model. This mixed approach places it in the middle rather than fully “Classical” in pedagogy terms.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Public materials reference “professional, qualified teachers” delivering instruction (two days on campus; collaboration with families). A Headmaster-led model is documented (Lead/Headmaster). This aligns with classical expectations of masterful teachers and mentors as living exemplars.

- Job postings show a structured faculty role (K-5 classroom teacher; 6th–8th adjunct teacher) with clear expectations, which indicates a professional faculty core.
- The “Collaborative” model emphasizes teachers as core actors within a unified curriculum delivered across on-campus and home days, reinforcing the living-curriculum/master-teacher concept.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: master-teacher/headmaster; professional, qualified teachers; living curriculum (implied by integrated curriculum and leadership); mentorship and collaboration (faculty-student collaboration implied by the collaborative model).
 - Negative keywords: none evident in public materials.
 - Estimated counts: Positive ~4–6 indicators; Negative 0.
 - Status justification: CLASSICAL.
- Why this rating
 - ACA presents a professional, guided-faculty model with designated leadership and clearly defined teacher roles within a classical framework, consistent with the “Faculty” criteria in the Six Elements lexicon.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - A central feature of ACA is robust parental partnership. Materials describe a “Collaborative Model” that actively involves parents in lesson delivery on homeschool days and expects parental covenant/signature for participation. The Family Covenant and active parent involvement are highlighted as core design features.
 - Admissions/enrollment materials emphasize family involvement, and the site highlights family events and opportunities for parental engagement (New Family Enrollment OPENS; “What sets us apart” emphasizes family-centered education; newsletters and community-building events).
 - The materials explicitly frame the school as partnering with families to educate the whole family unit, including guides for parent formation and book/study groups.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: partnership with families; parent covenant; co-teachers; family involvement; home–school collaboration; parent formation; community of learners; hospitality/open campus.
 - Negative keywords: none identified in public materials.
 - Estimated counts: Positive ~6–8 indicators; Negative 0.
 - Status justification: CLASSICAL.
- Why this rating
 - ACA’s explicit emphasis on family partnership, parental formation, and open campus events aligns strongly with the Parents & Community category in the classical rubric. The collaborative model and covenant language are textbook signals of classical-parent partnership.

Aggregate Ranking - Element 1: CLASSICAL - Element 2: CLASSICAL - Element 3: CLASSICAL - Element 4: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Element 5: CLASSICAL - Element 6: CLASSICAL

General assessment: CLASSICAL

What would move the needle - If Element 4 remains SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, implement more explicit Socratic/ seminar-based pedagogy for upper grades, with documented examples of Socratic discussions, seminars, and debates, and formal rhetoric performance opportunities tied to graded assessment. This would push Pedagogy further into CLASSICAL. - Strengthen explicit public articulation of Great Books/Great Conversation and Telos in mission statements and on the website, so that Great Books and “telos” language is as visible as grammar–logic–rhetoric and biblical formation. - Expand liturgical/community practices with clearly defined liturgical events (e.g., regular contemplative or worshipful elements in a formalized rhythm) to deepen the Liturgical and Communal Practices category, while staying aligned with the Gospel-centered, biblically anchored mission.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

By reading or using this document, you acknowledge and accept the limitations described above.